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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

THURSDAY, 08 OCTOBER 2026

15 must-know stories, 22 Prelims facts, 22 editorials and 17 explainers, picked from 1,002 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Jharkhand DGP appointment rule appears to be conflict with Prakash Singh verdict: Supreme Court

The Supreme Court observed that Jharkhand's regulations for appointing the Director General of Police appear to conflict with the Prakash Singh verdict. The Central government challenged the Jharkhand Head of Police Force Regulations, 2025, and DGP appointments made under them. The core issue is that the new state regulations permit appointing officers with less than six months remaining until retirement as DGP. The 2019 Supreme Court order in the Prakash Singh case clearly stated that only officers with at least six months of residual service should be recommended. Jharkhand appointed incumbent DGP Tadasha Mishra for a two-year term just one day before her scheduled retirement. The Central government also questioned the validity of prior DGP Anurag Gupta's appointment due to insufficient residual service. The Supreme Court gave the Jharkhand government one week to either revisit its DGP appointment rule or defend it. The Court also asked the amicus curiae to examine DGP appointment laws and practices across all states in India.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** Jharkhand · **Who:** Supreme Court, Central Government, Jharkhand Government, CJI Surya Kant, Tadasha Mishra, Raju Ramachandran · **Prelims:** Incumbent Jharkhand DGP Tadasha Mishra was appointed on December 30, 2025.; The challenged regulations are the Selection and Appointment of Director General and Inspector General of Police, Jharkhand Regulations, 2025.; The Supreme Court bench was led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Upholds judicial oversight on executive overreach in high-profile police appointments.; Reinforces the binding nature of the Prakash Singh police reform guidelines across all states.*

Static — The Prakash Singh v. Union of India landmark 2006 Supreme Court judgment directed sweeping police reforms to ensure functional autonomy for the police. Key directives in the Prakash Singh case included fixing a minimum tenure for the DGP and other key police officers to insulate them from political pressure. The judgment mandated a transparent merit-based selection process involving the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) for appointing DGPs.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Appointment

Bar & Bench: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, Times of India, ThePrint

GS2 MAKE NOTES

CAPF Act 2026 takes effect today

The Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Act, 2026 (9 of 2026) officially came into force on October 8, 2026. The Ministry of Home Affairs issued the enforcement notification following presidential assent received from President Droupadi Murmu on April 9. Top command postings in CAPFs will now be governed by explicit statutory law instead of earlier executive orders. Under the new law, 50 per cent of Inspector General (IG) posts are reserved for Indian Police Service (IPS) officers on deputation. For the rank of Additional Director General (ADG), at least 67 per cent of posts are reserved for IPS deputationists. At the apex level, the posts of Special Director General (SDG) and Director General (DG) are 100 per cent reserved for IPS officers. The government stated the legislation brings administrative clarity and ensures promotions and financial benefits for the cadre officers. Retired CAPF officials opposed the law, stating it discriminates against cadre officers who fought litigation to overcome career stagnation.

When: October 8, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** Ministry of Home Affairs, President Droupadi Murmu, Nityanand Rai · **Prelims:** The Act is officially known as the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Act, 2026 (9 of 2026).; President Droupadi Murmu gave presidential assent to the legislation on April 9.; 50 percent of Inspector General (IG) posts are reserved for IPS officers on deputation.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Replaces executive guidelines with a statutory framework for senior command appointments in CAPFs.; Codifies fixed deputation quotas for IPS officers at IG, ADG, SDG, and DG ranks.*

Static — Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) function under the Ministry of Home Affairs and assist in internal security, border guarding, and counter-insurgency. The Indian Police Service (IPS) is an All India Service under Article 312 of the Constitution, providing senior leadership to police and paramilitary forces. Cadre management in security forces involves balancing promotional aspirations of direct-entry service officers with deputation quotas from the IPS.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Internal Security · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

devdiscourse.com: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, Hindustan Times, NEXT IAS

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court to take up recall plea on Election Commission split verdict afresh

The Supreme Court agreed to examine an application seeking the recall of its September 23 split verdict regarding the 2023 law governing Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioner appointments. The recall application was mentioned before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana by Senior Advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan. The core issue revolves around whether challenges to the 2023 law should be referred to a larger Constitution Bench, which led to divergent views between Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma. Justice Dipankar Datta held that a larger-bench reference was not necessary, whereas Justice Sharma favoured such a reference, resulting in the split verdict. The recall plea raises a concern regarding a possible apprehension of bias involving Justice Sharma because his son serves as a standing counsel for the Election Commission of India. The underlying dispute challenges the 2023 law for altering the selection panel composition by excluding the Chief Justice of India. A separate curative petition has also been filed by another party against the split verdict to follow its own legal process.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Dipankar Datta, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, Senior Advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan · **Prelims:** The split verdict was delivered on September 23 by Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma.; The 2023 law governs the appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners.; Justice Satish Chandra Sharma's son is a standing counsel for the Election Commission of India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It tests procedural remedies like recall applications and curative petitions in matters involving split verdicts.; It touches upon judicial propriety and potential apprehensions of bias in high-stakes constitutional litigation.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional authority established under Article 324 to administer election processes in India. The 2023 Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners Act modified the appointment process, replacing the CJI on the selection committee with a Union Cabinet Minister. A split verdict occurs when a bench of two judges delivers differing opinions, requiring the matter to be referred to the Chief Justice for constitution of a larger bench.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

english.mathrubhumi.com: read the source · also reported by Live Law, India Legal, Hindustan Times

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India-EU FTA to be signed in Dec, trade deal expected to take effect by mid-2027: EU ambassador Paquet

India and the European Union are preparing to sign their long-awaited free trade agreement in December, with the deal expected to take effect by mid-2027. The European Commission has proposed a signature to the Council of Ministers, and the schedule of tariff reductions and facilitations has been published. The two sides are also negotiating a bilateral investment protection pact as a necessary complement to the trade deal to cover supply chains and investments. EU ambassador Jean-Éric Paquet noted that the investment pact talks are less complex than the tariff negotiations and aim to progress swiftly. Discussions are ongoing regarding the EU's carbon border adjustment mechanism (CBAM), with teams from Brussels scheduled to visit India in mid-October. India and Europe have established a climate fund of 500 million euros to support investments in clean tech and reduce carbon intensity. A Security and Defence Partnership is moving forward, with plans to set up a Defence Industries Forum and an administrative arrangement between navies. The EU aims to reduce financing for Russia's war through oil price caps and move completely out of Russian gas by 2027.

When: December 2026 · **Where:** India and Europe · **Who:** Jean-Éric Paquet · **Prelims:** Jean-Éric Paquet is the new EU ambassador in Delhi.; The climate fund agreed upon between India and Europe has a magnitude of 500 million euros.; The European Commission proposed the FTA signature to the Council of Ministers.

> ***Why it matters —*** *The unified economic space covers two billion people and 25 percent of global GDP, vastly expanding market access.; The Security and Defence Partnership opens new avenues for maritime cooperation, counter-terrorism, and defence industry collaboration.*

Static — The European Union is a political and economic union of 27 European member states, established by the Maastricht Treaty in 1993. A Free Trade Agreement (FTA) is an international treaty between two or more economies to reduce or eliminate import tariffs and non-tariff barriers. The Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) is an EU tool to put a fair price on carbon emitted during the production of carbon-intensive goods entering the EU.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Hindustan Times: read the source

Health

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

WHO Pandemic Agreement: India's Stakes & Global Health

India has highlighted global public goods, including digital health infrastructure, laboratory networks and One Health capacities. Developing countries demand financing before accepting costly commitments like extensive One Health surveillance. Developed countries remain cautious about binding technology-transfer and intellectual-property obligations. India seeks to build consensus in the WHO Pandemic Agreement without diluting national policy space. The US rejection of the Declaration illustrates the continuing sovereignty-versus-global-governance debate. India occupies a unique position as both a major pharmaceutical manufacturer and a developing country. India remains dependent on Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients imports and requires advanced technologies for medical devices. India aims to bridge the Global North and South by converting its domestic capabilities into global public goods.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Who:** WHO, India, United States · **Prelims:** Global Initiative on Digital Health was launched during India's G20 Presidency in 2023.; India is among the world's largest vaccine manufacturers by volume.; India remains significantly dependent on imports of Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for shaping equitable global health governance and pandemic response mechanisms.; Positions India as a leader and reliable supplier for the Global South.*

Static — The World Health Organization is a specialized agency of the United Nations responsible for international public health, established in 1948. The Global Initiative on Digital Health was launched during India's G20 Presidency in 2023 to promote interoperable digital-health systems. The National One Health Programme promotes integrated surveillance of human, animal and environmental health.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

nextias.com: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Government Expands Cancer Medicine Price Controls; Cancer Patients Expected to Save Rs. 2,500 Crore Annually

The government has approved a cap limiting trade margins on non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs to 30 percent of the Maximum Retail Price. The measure is expected to reduce medicine prices by up to 70 percent and save cancer patients Rs 2,500 crore annually. Essential cancer medicines were already under ceiling prices, but the new decision extends price protection to non-scheduled drugs outside that list. An expert committee under the Directorate General of Health Services will finalize the list of medicines, after which the NPPA will issue a notification. NPPA analysis showed non-scheduled anti-cancer medicines carry an average price mark-up of around 170 percent, sometimes reaching 700 percent or more. State authorities, patients, and civil society raised concerns regarding excessive prices and massive gaps between purchase prices and the MRP. Manufacturers of non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs will be required to maintain current production levels to ensure continued availability of medicines. The intervention covers all categories of non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs including branded, generic, imported, domestic, patented, and non-patented.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** India · **Who:** National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority, Directorate General of Health Services · **Prelims:** Cancer incidence in India is approximately 60 people per one lakh population.; Trade margins on non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs are capped at 30 percent of the MRP.; Expected annual savings for cancer patients are Rs 2,500 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces catastrophic out-of-pocket healthcare expenses for cancer patients and their families.; Curbs exploitative profit margins and unfair pricing practices in retail, hospital, and online pharmacies.*

Static — The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority is an apex body established in 1997 under the Department of Pharmaceuticals, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers. NPPA is tasked with fixing and revising prices of scheduled formulations and enforcing the provisions of the Drugs (Prices Control) Order. The Drugs (Prices Control) Order is an order issued by the Central Government under Section 3 of the Essential Commodities Act.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · *free copy on devdiscourse.com*

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Breaking: Supreme Court Directs Centre To Form Committee On Unethical Pharma Practices And Mandatory...

The Supreme Court directed the Union government to form a three-member committee to examine whether statutory regulations are needed to curb unethical pharma marketing practices. The bench comprising Justice Vikram Nath and Justice Sandeep Mehta passed the order while hearing a petition seeking legally enforceable rules governing pharma marketing and doctor-company interactions. The core issue debated is the imbalance where doctors face penalties for accepting freebies under existing rules, while pharmaceutical companies offering such inducements lack direct statutory penalties. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta informed the Court that the Centre agreed to set up the committee following inter-departmental discussions between the Departments of Pharmaceuticals, Health, and Legal Affairs. The existing framework includes the Uniform Code for Pharmaceutical Marketing Practices, 2024, which will continue to govern practices in the interim. Petitioners questioned the new committee, noting a high-level committee was already promised in a 2022 affidavit, and argued that voluntary codes fail to prevent undue influence on prescriptions. The Supreme Court observed that a regulatory framework's efficacy must be judged by its implementation and enforcement rather than just the mere existence of norms.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, Justice Vikram Nath, Justice Sandeep Mehta · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court bench was composed of Justice Vikram Nath and Justice Sandeep Mehta.; The newly ordered committee is a three-member body.; The committee is expected to submit its report within two months of its first meeting.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Addresses regulatory gaps between penalizing doctors versus penalizing pharmaceutical companies for unethical marketing.; Reinforces the constitutional right to health under Article 21 by emphasizing effective enforcement of public health standards.*

Static — The Uniform Code for Pharmaceutical Marketing Practices (UCPMP) is a set of guidelines issued by the government to regulate promotional activities and interactions between drug companies and healthcare professionals. Under Indian regulations, medical ethics and professional conduct for doctors are primarily overseen by the National Medical Commission (NMC) through its regulations. Article 21 of the Constitution guarantees the right to life and personal liberty, which the judiciary interprets to include the right to health and access to safe healthcare.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Judgment

cnbctv18.com: read the source · also reported by Hindustan Times, Business Standard

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST Council Meeting 2026: Tax officers' arrest powers scrapped, prosecution threshold raised to Rs 5 crore; no rate changes

The GST Council approved sweeping enforcement and procedural reforms under GST 2.0 to ease compliance, making no changes to tax rates. The Council removed the power of arrest under GST and raised the prosecution threshold from Rs 1 crore to Rs 5 crore. The general penalty under GST was reduced from Rs 25,000 to Rs 10,000, addressing business concerns over the criminalisation of routine disputes. Registration and refund timelines were streamlined, with 90% of refund claims to be sanctioned automatically within three working days of acknowledgement. Transit inspection rules were eased, allowing vehicles to be stopped only on specific intelligence and solely by origin and destination states. An optional compliance scheme was approved for small taxpayers with up to Rs 5 crore turnover supplying exclusively to consumers, allowing annual returns and quarterly tax payments. ITC was extended to ordinary business spending like employee health insurance, telecommunication towers, pipelines, free samples, and stock written off after expiry. Export benefits were expanded for Indian companies serving foreign clients via overseas branches and for work done in India on goods belonging to foreign clients.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** India · **Who:** GST Council, Union Finance Minister, State Finance Ministers · **Prelims:** The prosecution threshold under GST was raised from Rs 1 crore to Rs 5 crore.; The general penalty under GST was reduced from Rs 25,000 to Rs 10,000.; Tax officers' arrest powers under GST were completely scrapped.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces the risk of criminalisation for routine business disputes by eliminating arrest powers and lifting prosecution limits.; Improves working capital management and ease of doing business through automated refunds and simplified e-commerce and transit rules.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A of the Constitution, introduced by the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016. The Council is chaired by the Union Finance Minister, with the Minister of State for Finance and state Finance or Taxation Ministers as members. It is designed to make recommendations to the Union and State Governments on key GST issues, tax rates, exemptions, thresholds, and dispute resolution mechanisms.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on indiatoday.in · also reported by BusinessLine, PIB, Business Standard, Mint, Indian Express

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s WTO fisheries ratification: A pragmatic step, with more to negotiate

India deposited its Instrument of Acceptance for Phase 1 of the WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies on July 20, 2026. The ministry stated that the ratification addresses damaging fishing practices while safeguarding small-scale and artisanal fishers. Phase 1 specifically targets subsidies associated with illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing, overfished stocks, and unregulated high seas fishing. Contentious subsidies contributing to overcapacity and overfishing, such as fuel, gear, ice, and vessel construction, remain part of Phase 2. India continues to press for fair and differentiated treatment for developing countries in the ongoing Phase 2 negotiations. India's core demands include a 25-year transition period within its exclusive economic zone and subsidies assessed on a per-fisher basis. The Ministry emphasized that international rules must account for livelihood protection in developing nations rather than restricting public assistance.

When: 20 July 2026 · **Who:** Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying · **Prelims:** India deposited its Instrument of Acceptance on July 20, 2026.; Phase 1 targets illegal, unreported and unregulated (IUU) fishing, overfished stocks, and unregulated high seas fishing.; Phase 2 negotiations cover overcapacity and overfishing, including subsidies for fuel, gear, ice, and vessel construction.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Demonstrates India's commitment to global sustainability while protecting the livelihoods of millions of small-scale coastal fishers.; Keeps India's strategic negotiating position intact for Phase 2, demanding a 25-year transition period within exclusive economic zones.*

Static — The WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies aims to curb harmful subsidies that contribute to overfishing and depletion of global fish stocks. World Trade Organization (WTO) is the main international body dealing with global rules of trade between nations, founded in 1995. Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) is an area of the ocean extending up to 200 nautical miles from a nation's coast, where it has special rights regarding exploration and use of marine resources.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, International Relations, Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

PIB: read the source · free copy on nationalheraldindia.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI survey: Household inflation expectations hit 10% for next year

Indian households expect inflation to reach 10 per cent over the next one year, up from 9.4 per cent in July. The median inflation expectation for the next 12 months increased by 60 basis points, while the three-month expectation rose by 70 basis points to 9.9 per cent. Rising household inflation expectations reflect growing concerns over future living costs, influencing consumer spending and wage expectations. The RBI's Monetary Policy Committee raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50 per cent on October 7 amid these inflation concerns. Households' perception of current inflation increased to 8.4 per cent in September from 7.8 per cent in July. As many as 88.9 per cent of respondents expected general prices to rise over the next year, and 67.4 per cent anticipated prices increasing at a faster pace. Food prices remained a major concern, with 84.9 per cent of respondents expecting food prices to rise over the next three months. The survey was conducted between September 10 and 20 across 19 major cities, covering 5,987 respondents, and represents median household expectations rather than the official RBI forecast.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India (RBI) · **Prelims:** The RBI's September 2026 survey covered 5,987 respondents across 19 major cities.; The median inflation expectation for the next 12 months increased to 10 per cent.; The three-month inflation expectation rose to 9.9 per cent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Serves as an essential indicator for monetary policy formulation and rate-setting by the RBI.; Highlights persistent inflationary pressures and consumer anxieties regarding food prices and living costs.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is a statutory and institutionalized framework under the RBI Act, 1934, tasked with fixing the benchmark repo rate to contain inflation. Inflation expectations surveys conducted by central banks gauge the subjective views of households and businesses on future price movements, acting as a vital input for monetary policy.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on devdiscourse.com · also reported by BusinessLine, Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

One GST return a year? New scheme could ease compliance for 16 lakh small businesses

The GST Council approved in principle a simplified compliance scheme allowing certain small businesses to file just one GST return annually. The proposal was cleared at the 57th GST Council meeting chaired by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman. The core objective is to ease compliance burdens for small businesses that sell directly to retail consumers and account for less than one percent of total GST liability. The scheme is optional and targeted at taxpayers with an annual turnover of up to Rs 5 crore who deal exclusively with consumers. Under the framework, eligible businesses will pay GST every quarter while filing only a single return each year. Government estimates show that out of 1.05 crore active GST taxpayers, roughly 16.85 lakh report supplies only to consumers, with 16.66 lakh having turnover below Rs 5 crore. Because individual retail consumers do not claim input tax credit, returns from these sellers have limited impact on the broader GST credit chain. Detailed operational frameworks and necessary legislative amendments will be placed before the Council at its next meeting. The reforms are slated to take effect officially from April 1, 2027.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, GST Council · **Prelims:** Turnover threshold for the proposed scheme is up to Rs 5 crore.; The scheme was approved at the 57th GST Council meeting.; Total active GST taxpayers in India stand at around 1.05 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces the regulatory and compliance burden for over 16 lakh small businesses and retail shops.; Rationalises the compliance framework for taxpayers whose operations have minimal impact on the broader input tax credit chain.*

Static — The GST Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A of the Constitution of India by the 101st Amendment Act, 2016. The Council is chaired by the Union Finance Minister, with the Union Minister of State in charge of Revenue or Finance and Ministers in charge of Finance or Taxation from all states as members. It makes recommendations to the Union and State Governments on issues related to the Goods and Services Tax, tax rates, exemptions, and thresholds.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on zeenews.india.com

Infrastructure & Energy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 5,070 crore PM Surya Sarovar Yojana to develop 5,000 MW floating solar capacity

The Union Cabinet approved the Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana with an outlay of Rs 5,070 crore to develop floating solar photovoltaic projects. The scheme aims to develop 5,000 MW of floating solar capacity along with 10,000 MWh of co-located energy storage systems. Projects under the scheme will be sanctioned between FY 2026-27 and FY 2030-31, with financial assistance disbursed until FY 2032-33. The National Institute of Solar Energy estimated India's floating solar potential at around 102.18 GWp across inland water bodies. The Centre will provide Central Financial Assistance of Rs 1 crore per MW for eligible floating solar projects after successful commissioning. Project developers can receive up to Rs 50 lakh per project for feasibility studies, bathymetry, hydrography surveys and environmental assessments. The initiative is expected to reduce nearly 10 million tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions annually and generate 16,000-17,000 jobs. Integration of energy storage systems aims to strengthen grid reliability and stability of renewable power across states and Union Territories.

When: FY 2026-27 to FY 2032-33 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, National Institute of Solar Energy · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay of PM Surya Sarovar Yojana is Rs 5,070 crore.; Target floating solar capacity is 5,000 MW with 10,000 MWh of energy storage.; Current India floating solar capacity stands at around 700 MW.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands India's clean energy infrastructure by utilizing under-utilized water bodies and reservoirs.; Reduces carbon emissions by nearly 10 million tonnes annually and supports national climate targets.*

Static — Floating solar photovoltaic systems involve installing solar panels on mounting structures that float on water bodies like reservoirs, lakes and ponds. National Institute of Solar Energy is an autonomous institution under the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, serving as the apex national body for solar energy R&D. Central Financial Assistance refers to monetary grants provided by the central government to support infrastructure and renewable energy projects.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by DD News

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Nameri Tiger Reserve secures CA|TS approval, completes Assam's four-reserve conservation milestone

Nameri Tiger Reserve in Assam secured the Conservation Assured | Tiger Standards (CA|TS) Approved status on September 10. The approval was granted following an assessment and subsequent approval by the CA|TS International Executive Committee. This achievement makes Nameri the fourth tiger reserve in Assam to receive this international conservation recognition. The recognition places Nameri alongside Kaziranga, Manas, and Orang, bringing all four of Assam's tiger reserves under the framework. CA|TS is a global framework assessing tiger reserve management effectiveness across wildlife protection, habitat management, and community participation. The status acknowledges efforts to strengthen protection mechanisms, improve scientific monitoring, and implement conservation measures. The milestone also acknowledges the role of forest officials, frontline personnel, and stakeholders in protecting the reserve. Located on the north bank of the Brahmaputra, Nameri has ecological linkages with Arunachal Pradesh and the wider Brahmaputra Valley.

When: September 10 · **Where:** Assam · **Who:** CA|TS International Executive Committee · **Prelims:** Nameri Tiger Reserve is located on the north bank of the Brahmaputra in Assam.; The CA|TS approval for Nameri was granted on September 10.; Assam has four tiger reserves: Kaziranga, Manas, Orang, and Nameri.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Brings all four tiger reserves in Assam under a unified international conservation management framework.; Highlights improved scientific monitoring, habitat management, and wildlife protection in Nameri Tiger Reserve.*

Static — The Conservation Assured | Tiger Standards (CA|TS) is a global conservation tool that sets minimum standards for effective management of tiger reserves. CA|TS was developed by tiger range countries, international conservation organisations, and tiger experts to evaluate management practices. Tiger reserves in India are designated under Project Tiger, launched in 1973 by the Government of India under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Species, Place in news

msn.com: read the source · also reported by ForumIAS, ThePrint

Science & Technology

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Union Minister Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw Launches World Bank Group's 'World Development Report 2026: The Promise of Artificial Intelligence' in New Delhi

Union Minister Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw launched the World Bank Group's World Development Report 2026: The Promise of Artificial Intelligence in New Delhi, highlighting AI's role in transforming developing economies. The Report examines the opportunities and challenges that Artificial Intelligence (AI) presents for developing economies, and sets out a framework for countries to harness AI for development through adoption, adaptation and advancement. The launch was organised by the IndiaAI Mission, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India, in collaboration with the World Bank Group.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Shri Ashwini Vaishnaw, Union Minister for Electronics and Information Technology · **Prelims:** The Report launched is titled 'World Development Report 2026: The Promise of Artificial Intelligence'.; The launch event was held at The Oberoi in New Delhi.; The launch was organised by the IndiaAI Mission, MeitY, in collaboration with the World Bank Group.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a strategic framework for developing countries to leverage artificial intelligence for inclusive growth.; Highlights India's practical applications of AI in agriculture and healthcare to democratize technology.*

Static — The World Development Report is an annual flagship publication produced by the World Bank Group since 1978, offering in-depth analysis on specific aspects of economic development. The IndiaAI Mission is an initiative by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) to build a robust artificial intelligence ecosystem in India. Artificial Intelligence (AI) refers to the simulation of human intelligence in machines programmed to think, learn, adapt, and solve complex problems.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Science & Technology, International Relations, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

PIB: read the source · also reported by Hindustan Times, Times of India, Indian Express, The Hindu

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Skyroot to launch first private orbital mission Vikram-1, PM Modi calls it ‘historic frontier’ for India’s space journey

Prime Minister Narendra Modi hailed the maiden launch of Vikram-1, India's first privately developed orbital launch vehicle, as a historic new frontier. The launch was driven by India's space-sector reforms which create new opportunities for youth innovation and entrepreneurial enterprise. Developed by Hyderabad-based Skyroot Aerospace, the four-stage rocket is designed to provide rapid and on-demand launch services. The mission, named Mission Aagaman, lifted off at 11:30 AM from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota. Vikram-1 is a 24-metre launch vehicle built using an all-carbon composite structure, powered by three solid-fuel stages and a liquid-fuel orbital adjustment module. The vehicle is designed to deploy payloads weighing up to 350 kg into a 450-km Low Earth Orbit independently of government launch vehicles. The payload includes a lab-grown Diamond Lotus developed by Bengaluru-based Cosmos Diamonds. IN-SPACe Technical Director Rajesh Jothi noted that private space startups in India have grown from five or six to more than 400 following 2020 reforms.

When: 2026-10-08 · **Where:** Sriharikota · **Who:** Skyroot Aerospace, PM Narendra Modi, S. Somanath, Rajesh Jothi, Naga Bharath Daka · **Prelims:** Vikram-1 is a 24-metre launch vehicle built using an all-carbon composite structure.; The vehicle is designed to deploy payloads up to 350 kg into a 450-km LEO.; The launch took place from Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota under Mission Aagaman.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Demonstrates the capability of Indian startups to independently build and launch orbital rockets.; Strengthens India's position in the global small satellite and commercial launch market.*

Static — India's space sector reforms initiated in 2020 established IN-SPACe (Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre) to act as a single-window autonomous agency under Department of Space. IN-SPACe facilitates, promotes, and authorizes private sector entities to undertake space activities including building launch vehicles and satellites. The Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC) located in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh, is India's primary spaceport managed by ISRO.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

MoSPI signs MoU with Pahle India Foundation, New Delhi to strengthen collaboration in Official Statistics, Research and Data Analysis

The National Statistics Office under MoSPI signed an MoU with Pahle India Foundation in New Delhi. The collaboration aims to enhance official statistics, research, data analysis, capacity building, and knowledge sharing. The partnership provides a broad framework for mutual cooperation based on the priority areas of MoSPI. Dr. Saurabh Garg, Secretary of MoSPI, and Dr. Rajiv Kumar, Chairperson of PIF, graced the signing ceremony.

PIB: source

HEALTH QUICK READ

Union Health Minister Shri J.P. Nadda Launches JOSH Teams to Accelerate Youth-Led TB Elimination Efforts

The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare launched JOSH (Joint Squad for Health) Teams at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi. The initiative was launched in collaboration with the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports and the Ministry of Defence. The core issue is accelerating grassroots community participation, awareness, early diagnosis, and treatment completion to eliminate tuberculosis.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

NBA receives Rs 9.68 crore under Access and Benefit Sharing Framework during April–September 2026

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change released the official sectoral and company-wise contribution data for April-September 2026. The National Biodiversity Authority collected Rs 9.68 crore under the Access and Benefit Sharing framework from users of biological resources between April and September 2026.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Anti-Corruption (Amendment) Bill passed in Parliament without a vote

The Bill's recent passage through Parliament without a vote put it in the news. The Anti-Corruption (Amendment) Bill was passed in Parliament without requiring a formal vote.

Newswire: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Maharashtra Launches ‘CM-SRISTHI’ Scheme To Boost AI, Quantum Computing, Semiconductors & Futuristic Tech

The Maharashtra State Department of Higher and Technical Education launched the CM-SRISTHI scheme to transform the state into a global hub for research and futuristic technologies. The initiative is structured for a five-year implementation period spanning from 2026-27 to 2030-31, aligning with the Viksit Maharashtra @2047 vision. The core objective is to bridge the gap between academia, research, and market needs by developing cutting-edge technology and a skilled workforce.

freepressjournal.in: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Living Planet Report 2026

The WWF and ZSL released the Living Planet Report 2026 titled The Science of Hope, noting a 73% average decline in monitored wildlife populations between 1970 and 2022. The decline is primarily driven by habitat loss, overexploitation, and climate change, which together account for roughly 67% of total biodiversity loss. Freshwater ecosystems suffered the steepest collapse at 85%, followed by terrestrial ecosystems at 69% and marine ecosystems at 59%.

ForumIAS: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

NHRC, India takes suo motu cognizance of the reported sexual harassment of three journalists by Delhi Police personnel during a protest at Jantar Mantar, New Delhi on 3rd October 2026

The National Human Rights Commission took suo motu cognizance of media reports alleging sexual harassment of three women journalists by Delhi Police personnel. The incident occurred during a protest at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on October 3, 2026, against the Chief Election Commissioner and electoral roll revisions. The core issue involves serious allegations of human rights violations and police misconduct against media personnel covering a public demonstration.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

India joins US, 13 economies in joint statement to address global excess capacity after G20 meeting

India joined the United States and 13 other economies in signing a joint ministerial statement addressing global structural excess capacity and production. The statement calls for eliminating structural excess capacity and ending non-market policies and practices that distort markets. The 15 participating economies argue that such capacity in manufacturing sectors poses a fundamental challenge to the global economy.

tribuneindia.com: source

ECONOMY | QUICK READ

India’s regulatory framework for satellite communication services is fair and non-discriminatory

The Indian government rejected allegations that the country's regulatory framework for satellite communication services is discriminatory. The clarification followed social media posts by Tesla and SpaceX CEO Elon Musk accusing unnamed oligarchs of blocking Starlink. Musk claimed that Starlink was prevented from launching its services in India to maintain a monopolistic market chokehold.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

India, Ghana sign MoUs on agricultural, biodiversity research during Jaishankar's visit

India and Ghana exchanged two Memoranda of Understanding during External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar's visit to Accra. The visit is part of the first leg of Jaishankar's three-nation tour to Ghana, Cote d'Ivoire, and Ethiopia from October 6 to 10. The first MoU was signed between the Indian Council of Agricultural Research and Ghana's CSIR-Crops Research Institute.

msn.com: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE | AWARD | QUICK READ

2026 Nobel Prize in Literature

Canadian author and poet Anne Carson has won the 2026 Nobel Prize in Literature. The award was announced by the Swedish Academy located in Stockholm. She was recognized for her bold and inventive oeuvre that engages playfully with the classical tradition. The Swedish Academy praised her work for creating new forms for contemporary literature and engaging with ancient Greek literature.

Hindustan Times: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Siang River

Protests and clashes broke out against surveys for a proposed mega hydropower project in the Siang and Upper Siang districts of Arunachal Pradesh. The protests were triggered by local opposition to pre-construction survey activities for the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project. The core issue involves balancing regional infrastructure and flood-control needs with the livelihood and displacement concerns of local indigenous communities.

ForumIAS: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

PM to participate in Valedictory Session of Departmental Summit on Women and Child Development on 9th October

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will participate in the valedictory session of the Departmental Summit on Women and Child Development on October 9, 2026, at Sushma Swaraj Bhawan in New Delhi. The two-day summit, held on October 8 and 9, brings together political leaders and senior officials dealing with women and child development from all states.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

India Highlights Regional Energy Cooperation and Energy Security at 20th EAS Energy Ministers' Meeting

India participated in the 20th East Asia Summit Energy Ministers Meeting in Manila, emphasizing regional energy cooperation, the ASEAN Power Grid, and its own renewable energy milestones. Union Minister of State for Power and New & Renewable Energy, Shri Shripad Yesso Naik, represented India at the 20th East Asia Summit Energy Ministers' Meeting held in Manila, Philippines, today.

PIB: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE QUICK READ

Ambaji Mohanthal Prasad Gets GI Tag, Certificate to be Handed Over on First Day of Navratri

The GI tag is in the news because the official certificate is scheduled to be handed over on the first day of Navratri. The traditional Mohanthal prasad of the Ambaji temple in Gujarat has been awarded a Geographical Indication tag.

GujaratSamachar English: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

Maharashtra Cabinet Approves Rs 31000 Cr Road Projects Secures Aiib

The cabinet approval and AIIB funding arrangement for these major road projects put the story in the news. The Maharashtra cabinet has approved road projects worth Rs 31,000 crore with funding secured from the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB).

Projects Today: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Supreme Court Sets Aside High Court Judgment on Bar Council Elections Due to Lack of Jurisdiction. The Bar Council of Kerala's Term Expired Without Valid Extension, Rendering Elections Invalid Under Section 8A of the Advocates Act, 1961.

The Supreme Court delivered its ruling setting aside the High Court judgment on Bar Council elections due to lack of jurisdiction. The Supreme Court set aside a High Court judgment concerning Bar Council elections, ruling that the elections held after the expiration of the Bar Council of Kerala's term without a valid extension were invalid under Section 8A of the Advocates Act, 1961.

Lawtext: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Ghana Cabinet clears BRICS bid as Jaishankar visits Accra

Ghana's Cabinet has approved a decision to seek membership of BRICS and will formally apply to join the grouping. The announcement was made by Ghana's Foreign Minister Sam Okudzeto Ablakwa during talks with visiting Indian External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar. Ablakwa stated that the BRICS bid aims to diversify international partnerships and support Ghana's economic transformation and resource sovereignty.

ptinews.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Haryana Expands Chirayu-Ayushman Bharat Scheme to Higher-Income Families

The Haryana Government has expanded the Chirayu-Ayushman Bharat scheme to cover families with an annual income of more than Rs. 1.80 lakh. Higher-income families can now access cashless healthcare benefits by paying a nominal annual premium based on their income slabs. Eligibility is determined using the verified annual income recorded in the Parivar Pehchan Patra database.

drishtiias.com: source

DEFENCE SCHEME QUICK READ

ICGS Shaunak Arrives In Perth For QUAD-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission

The arrival of the Indian Coast Guard ship in Perth for the QUAD maritime mission put it in the news. ICGS Shaunak has reached Perth in Australia to participate in the QUAD-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission.

thepublicworld.com: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

SAREX-26 Maritime Search and Rescue Exercise Concludes Successfully Off Paradip Coast

The 12th National Maritime Search and Rescue Exercise SAREX-26 concluded successfully off the coast of Paradip. Director General of the Indian Coast Guard Paramesh Sivamani witnessed the exercise on site. Ships, helicopters, Dornier aircraft of the Coast Guard, Indian Navy ships, and Indian Air Force C-130J aircraft participated. Customs vehicles and other stakeholder agencies also took part with coordinated execution.

newsonair.gov.in: source

ECONOMY JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Supreme Court Allows Union of India's Appeals in Excise Incentive Withdrawal Case — Policy Change Upheld as Prospective and in Public Interest. The Court held that the impugned notification was not retrospective and promissory estoppel did not bar the g

The Supreme Court delivered its verdict upholding the government's withdrawal of excise incentives. The Supreme Court allowed the Union of India's appeals in an excise incentive withdrawal case, ruling that the policy change was prospective and justified in the public interest.

Lawtext: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 GS3 India’s Stakes in the Global Pandemic Agreement

India delivered official remarks on the Political Declaration for Pandemic Prevention, Preparedness, and Response at the UN High-Level Meeting in New York. The WHO Pandemic Agreement aims to ensure equitable access to countermeasures, stronger disease surveillance, and technology transfer globally. The core debate pits High-Income Countries resisting mandatory tech transfers against Low- and Middle-Income Countries demanding guaranteed financing and distribution. The Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing system remains the critical outstanding annex holding up final ratification of the agreement.

The Hindu

GS3 Calibrating India’s Inbound Investment Framework

India recorded a gross inward FDI of $94.8 billion in FY26, ranking 11th globally according to UNCTAD. Investment pledges face slow conversion into physical projects due to domestic friction between the Centre, States, and agencies. International project finance remains a quarter below its 2021 peak, and India follows this global downward trend. Greenfield data centre investments reached $7 billion in the first three quarters of 2025, lagging behind several nations.

The Hindu

GS3 Adequate response: on the RBI and inflation

The Reserve Bank of India raised the policy repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% and shifted its stance from neutral to calibrated tightening. This is the first rate hike since February 2023, triggered by retail inflation remaining above the 4% medium-term target for three consecutive months. The core issue is balancing inflation control through higher borrowing costs against maintaining sustainable economic growth amidst domestic and global uncertainties.

The Hindu

GS3 From the brink to a comeback, hope for India’s wildlife

India sustains nearly 8 percent of global flora and 7.5 percent of fauna across four global biodiversity hotspots, with high endemism and over a thousand species categorized as threatened. Targeted conservation frameworks like the National Red List Roadmap aim to produce National Red Data Books by 2030 to bridge the data deficit where only 7.2 percent of fauna is assessed. Species recovery programs funded by the Integrated Development of Wildlife Habitats scheme support recovery across 24 critically endangered wildlife species.

The Hindu

GS3 Best of Opinion: More rate hikes imminent as RBI revises policy cycle

Published as a compilation of key expert opinions on economic policy and institutional developments. An overview of contemporary opinions examining monetary policy shifts, tax reforms, and institutional changes. From the RBI's shift to calibrated tightening and health-insurance copayments to India's tax reform journey, aviation security, today's opinions examine policy trade-offs and institutional change

Business Standard

GS2 GS3 AI companions and child safety

AI chatbots are increasingly becoming emotional companions for children, creating new concerns regarding child safety and psychological well-being. Prolonged interaction with AI companions may cause emotional dependence, psychological manipulation, and exposure to harmful or inappropriate advice. Unlike conventional cybercrime, psychological harm develops gradually through thousands of seemingly harmless interactions, making detection very difficult. India's existing laws like the IT Act 2000, DPDP Act 2023, and POCSO Act 2012 lack a comprehensive framework for AI psychological risks.

The Hindu

GS2 Rosters and the reform question

It appears amid ongoing discussions on institutional transparency and the administrative powers of the judiciary. The editorial discusses the systemic questions surrounding judicial case allocation and roster management. Rosters and the reform question

Deccan Herald

GS3 RBI’s focus on inflation is timely

The Reserve Bank of India raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% and shifted its policy stance to 'calibrated tightening'. This policy action marked the first rate hike in nearly four years by the central bank. Interest-rate-sensitive sectors including banking, NBFCs, realty, and automobiles experienced sharp selling pressure following the announcement. RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra stated that the re-escalation of the West Asia conflict has negatively weighed on global economic sentiment.

msn.com

GS3 Tigers have Munna, elephants have Ramu. Other endangered species need their icons

Munna, a male tiger in Kanha Tiger Reserve, lived to age 19 and attracted millions of visitors due to forehead stripes resembling the word CAT. Central Indian folklore and modern parks show a long history of naming iconic tigers like Lungra, Kankati, and Machli based on unique features. Research in Frontiers in Ecology and Environment labels such animals with unique traits as flagship individuals, serving as ambassadors for their species.

ThePrint

GS3 Property Taxation Needs Structural Reform

India's urban centres face rising demands for infrastructure and public services due to rapid urbanisation and ageing infrastructure. Property tax is the most important own-source revenue of municipal bodies, yet India's cumulative property tax is only 0.15-0.2 percent of GDP. Property taxation involves three stages: enumeration, valuation and assessment, and billing and collection, with weaknesses at each stage. Incomplete property enumeration, outdated records, and manual record-keeping reduce the accuracy of the tax base and limit municipal revenues.

The Hindu

GS3 IRDAI and the avoidable art of regulatory jaywalking

The editorial discusses how recent strict policy adjustments by IRDAI regarding commission payments have negatively impacted investor confidence and stock values in the insurance industry. The transition from a lenient regulatory approach to a more rigorous one has sharply impacted stock values. Concerns over commission payments prompted this swift regulatory action, which may have been excessive.

Economic Times

GS3 Much needed policy adjustment

The editorial highlights the RBI's recent signals regarding a shift toward a tightening monetary policy stance. The Reserve Bank of India has signaled a measured policy tightening cycle ahead due to rising inflation risks. With inflation risks rising, RBI signals a measured tightening cycle ahead

Business Standard

GS3 RBI’s repo rate hike: Inflation must be tackled in a global context weighing against macro stability

The RBI implemented a repo rate hike to address persistent inflationary pressures in the economy. The Reserve Bank of India has announced its first repo rate hike since early 2023 to tackle domestic inflation while balancing broader macroeconomic stability. Macro stability, however, covers far more than domestic price levels—and it’s an external challenge that may prove harder to stare down.

Mint

GS3 Rupee is undervalued, not unmoored: RBI must ride out global market turbulence

The rupee’s weakness reflects global capital-flow turbulence rather than a deterioration in India’s economic fundamentals, with its inflation-adjusted value at levels last seen during the 2013-14 taper tantrum. RBI must contain volatility without defending a particular exchange-rate level, while higher interest rates and inflation control help restore investor confidence.

Economic Times

GS2 GS3 BRICS Needs To Address CBAM Consequences

The piece is in the news due to ongoing global debates surrounding climate protectionism and the EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism. The article discusses the necessity for BRICS nations to collectively address the impacts of unilateral carbon border taxes through harmonized carbon accounting and cap-and-trade norms. A common framework for carbon accounting and cap-and-trade norms can make a difference

BusinessLine

GS3 Chance and happenstance: on the Nobel Prize in Chemistry

The publication of the editorial was triggered by the announcement of the Nobel Prize in Chemistry. An editorial reflecting on the Nobel Prize in Chemistry, examining the interplay of chance, happenstance, and biological preferences. Bias is more than human sociology; life makes choices with definite preferences

The Hindu

GS2 Opinion: Opinion | Pakistan's Saudi Pact Is Now Entering Dangerous Territory

The Makkah Joint Defence Agreement was signed between Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, and Turkey in August to strengthen collective deterrence amid West Asian conflicts. The pact states that an armed attack against one member is an attack on all, though it initially lacked institutional foundations and operational experience. Following Houthi-led attacks on Saudi facilities, defence and foreign ministers met in Riyadh on October 5 for an emergency session of the Strategic Political and Defence Committee.

NDTV

GS3 Can mobile procurement gain traction?

The initiative is in the news because it requires critical policy tweaks to achieve wider traction and effectiveness. Uttar Pradesh has initiated a pilot project for mobile procurement of wheat at the Minimum Support Price to assist farmers. However, this initiative needs to be tweaked for it to be effective

BusinessLine

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | RBI's proposed committee for financial markets is timely: Here's how it may work best

The proposal was highlighted in an editorial discussing the need for the RBI to better understand trading floor dynamics and spot stability risks early. The Reserve Bank of India has proposed a new committee for financial markets to establish a formal interface with market participants and improve risk monitoring. An integrated formal interface with financial market participants would give the Reserve Bank of India a closer ear to how trading floors interact, which could help it spot contagion effects and stability risks early.

Mint

GS3 MPC takes note of economic reality

The Monetary Policy Committee of the Reserve Bank of India increased the policy repo rate by 25 basis points. The decision aligns with expectations and acknowledges the tension between resilient domestic momentum and a turbulent external environment. India's GDP growth forecast for the fiscal year has been revised upwards from 6.7% to 7.1%. The inflation forecast has been moved up from 5% to 5.2% alongside an upward revision in expected crude oil prices.

Hindustan Times

GS2 S Jaishankar wants India to de-risk as US-China ties change. First comes strength at home

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar raised questions on how India can de-risk, diversify, and extract value from existing partnerships amidst changing US-China ties. The author argues that moving from resilience to action requires connecting domestic strength with external engagement and constantly reassessing foreign policy assumptions. The core issue is that interdependence can become an instrument of coercion, and traditional labels like allies and adversaries do not guarantee diplomatic outcomes.

ThePrint

GS1 GS2 Gen Z protests: Education and jobs in a free and open society are the top priorities of this generation

The piece is in the news due to growing discussions surrounding Gen Z protests and the urgent socio-economic demands of the younger demographic. The editorial discusses how India's massive Gen Z population prioritizes education and jobs, warning that a youth bulge can lead to dissidence without proper policies. In India, this is the bulkiest age cohort with over 400 million people. A youth bulge needn't always boost growth.

Mint

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Why have SLBCs/UTLBCs been asked to report SC beneficiary data for key government schemes for jobs and entrepreneurship?: Explained The directive came into focus to ensure better monitoring of priority sector credit and financial inclusion for marginalized communities. SLBCs and UTLBCs have been directed to report data on Scheduled Caste beneficiaries for key government schemes relating to employment and entrepreneurship.

The Hindu

Why is the role of SIR tribunals in West Bengal under scrutiny Questions raised over the electoral re-enrolment drive and its potential to disenfranchise voters in civic polls have put SIR tribunals in the news. The functioning and role of SIR tribunals in West Bengal are facing scrutiny over a fresh re-enrolment drive of electors that might deprive lakhs of their voting rights in civic polls.

The Hindu

Circular Economy – Significance & Challenges India faces an acute resource challenge, forcing a choice between extracting virgin resources or adopting a circular economy model. A circular economy aims to minimise waste and maximise the reuse, repair, refurbishment, and recycling of products. Core principles include designing out waste, keeping materials in use, regenerating natural systems, and ensuring resource efficiency.
ForumIAS

What is the impact of 25 basis points repo rate hike on borrowers? The Reserve Bank of India raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50 percent, marking the first rate increase since February 2023. The rate hike was accompanied by a shift to a stance of calibrated tightening, signaling that future moves depend on inflation and economic conditions.
The Hindu

GST Council meeting today: What to expect on reforms, decriminalisation The 57th Goods and Services Tax Council meeting in New Delhi on October 8 addresses major compliance reforms. The agenda features simpler registration, streamlined Input Tax Credit procedures, and changes to service export definitions. Proposals include removing standalone arrest provisions under Section 69 of the Central Goods and Services Tax Act.
freepressjournal.in

UK renames consulate to Jerusalem as 'mission' amid sanctions row with Israel The UK scaled down its consular operations in Jerusalem, renaming the consulate to the UK Mission in Jerusalem following a diplomatic row with Israel. The crisis was triggered by UK-led sanctions announced by Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband targeting Israeli settlements in the occupied West Bank.
Hindustan Times

No rate cuts, but big GST relief: 8 reforms on refunds, ITC, registration and enforcement The GST Council introduced these significant administrative changes and relief measures while leaving tax rates unchanged. The GST Council approved eight major process reforms to ease registration, speed up refunds, widen input tax credit, and rationalise enforcement mechanisms.
Economic Times

First hike in over 3 years may not be last; repo rate can rise by another 75 basis points An announcement regarding the interest rate hike and future policy trajectory put the repo rate revisions in the news. The central bank implemented its first interest rate hike in over three years, with potential for further increases totaling 75 basis points.
Indian Express

India is signing bilateral investment treaties again. What changed after the 2016 reset? Recent diplomatic engagements and newly signed bilateral investment pacts have brought India's post-2016 investment treaty strategy back into focus. India is renewing its engagement with bilateral investment treaties after revising its model treaty framework in 2016 to protect state regulatory powers.
Indian Express

WHO prequalifies Serum Institute of India's quadrivalent HPV vaccine, CERVAVAC The WHO prequalification of CERVAVAC was reported as a major development for cervical cancer prevention globally. The World Health Organization has granted prequalification to the Serum Institute of India's quadrivalent HPV vaccine, CERVAVAC. The development is significant for India as well as the global effort to prevent cervical cancer
The Hindu

2026 Chemistry Nobel: Mirror-image molecules and the chemistry of life Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai won the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for solving a long-standing puzzle involving asymmetric mirror-image molecules. Kenso Soai is 76 years old and Japanese, while Henri Kagan is 95 years old and French, making Kagan the third-oldest Nobel laureate.
news.abplive.com

Explained | What is Pacific Pre-COP31? Union Minister Bhupender Yadav led the Indian delegation at the UNFCCC Pacific Pre-COP31 meetings. Pre-COP31 is being co-hosted by Australia, Fiji, and Tuvalu from October 5 to 8 in Nadi, Fiji, and Tuvalu. Pre-COP is a preparatory meeting bringing together 30 to 50 countries to discuss key issues ahead of the annual COP conference.
onmanorama.com

How does detention differ from arrest? Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders were recently detained in New Delhi while protesting for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh. Detention refers to the temporary restriction of a person's liberty by authorities without formally charging them with a crime, typically for preventive purposes.
ForumIAS

From 'quantum-enhanced' to 'quantum-safe': Why banks are preparing in advance for the new big threat The rapid advancement of quantum computing capabilities has triggered proactive preparation among global banks to safeguard sensitive financial data. Banks are actively preparing for future cybersecurity risks posed by quantum computing by transitioning toward quantum-safe cryptographic systems.
Indian Express

Is India's inflation problem spreading beyond food and fuel prices? Recent economic data showing August inflation rising to 4.8% has sparked debate on whether price pressures are broadening. India's inflation rose to 4.8% in August from 3.4% in March, driven largely by food and fuel, while core prices and services also show wider pressure.
Business Standard

Why Alaska LNG matters to Trump and why South Korea hasn't signed on US Vice President JD Vance stated that the US will build the Alaska LNG project with or without South Korea. The remarks followed US President Donald Trump announcement that South Korea would invest $200 billion in US projects including the pipeline.
theprint.in

What India's stance on global overcapacity could mean for US tariffs The strategic importance of industrial overcapacity and trade tariffs in global economic forums has put India's policy stance in the spotlight. An explanation of India's evolving policy stance on global industrial overcapacity and how it intersects with United States tariff policies.
Indian Express

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Next-Gen GST Process Reforms (Economy) PIB
- 16th Finance Commission recommends one-time grant to urban local bodies for merging peri-urban villages (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- India, Canada agree to deepen cooperation in countering terrorism, organised crime, cybercrime (International Relations) DD News
- Keralam constitutes University Finance Commission with B.A. Prakash as chairperson (Education) The Hindu
- RBI rate hike will not stem outflows, leaving central bank in a bind (Economy) Economic Times
- GST Council Meeting Oct 2026: List of decisions taken - Arrest, prosecution, general penalty and more (Economy) Mint
- From ponds, roads to solar lights: How rural job guarantee work changed in 20 yrs (Governance & Policy) Hindustan Times
- 'Overshoot is not a reason to surrender': UN calls for accelerated climate action ahead of COP31 summit (Environment & Ecology) UN News
- CAPF Act that governs officer posts, deputation comes into force (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- RBI's first big liquidity mop-up after rate hike falls short as banks park less than half the target (Economy) Economic Times
- BSDMA Issues Crowd Management Guidelines for Major Events in Bihar (Disaster Management) Drishti IAS
- With PM Modi set to visit Ottawa, India & Canada back CEPA (International Relations) Times of India
- At Pre-COP31, India Links Higher Climate Ambition to Finance and Technology Support (Environment & Ecology) The Policy Edge
- Japanese PM Sanae Takaichi Arrives in India for 16th India-Japan Annual Summit (International Relations) DD News
- Supreme Court Upholds Implementation of Medical Admission Scheme — Directs All India Entrance Examination for MBBS/BDS Courses. (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- Exports to hit $1 trillion this fiscal: Piyush Goyal (Economy) Economic Times
- BrahMos and Akash, India's strategic missile exports, opening new markets (Defence) The Tribune
- India's tiger population reaches 3,682, reserves rise to 58: Bhupender Yadav (Environment & Ecology) DD News
- Can a Nationalisation Scheme Exclude Private Operators? Supreme Court Clarifies (Polity & Constitution) The Law Observer
- India, South Korea announce 25 key outcomes, elevate ties to 'futuristic partnership' (International Relations) DD News
- RBI hikes rates after nearly 4 years and rings alarm bells. More pain incoming? (Economy) India Today
- Character and Conduct as the Foundation of Moral Authority (Ethics & Integrity) NEXT IAS
- Procedural Violation Will Not Vitiate Seizure But Can Affect Evidentiary Value : Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- Repo Rate Raised to 5.50% by RBI amid Challenging Global Uncertainty, Inflation (Economy) Moneylife
- Livestock sector expands as Kisan Credit Card coverage crosses 50 lakh farmers, milk output rises to 247.87 MT (Agriculture & Allied) DD News
- Astra Mk1 and Mk2 Complete Developmental Trials with Enhanced Ranges, Set for IAF Evaluation: Report (Defence) Defence.in
- Explain how the establishment of NewSpace India Limited (NSIL) and IN-SPACe aims to democratize and boost India's share in the global space economy. (Science & Technology) GKToday
- Can State Rules Restrict Timber Transport? Supreme Court Says No (Polity & Constitution) The Law Observer
- Tamil Nadu Hindi row explained: From 'chutney' to Highway signboard (Society) The Hindu
- 'Race to bottom'—World Bank red-flags India's 20-yr tax holiday for foreign firms using local data centres (Economy) ThePrint
- India to launch Index of Services Production in July 2026 to track services sector growth (Economy) DD News
- No more input tax credit block for companies buying insurance cover (Economy) BusinessLine
- PM-RAHAT Scheme: Road Accident Victims Can Get Rs. 1.5 Lakh Cashless Treatment (Governance & Policy) Trade Brains
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurates 10th edition of India Mobile Congress (Infrastructure & Energy) PIB
- Govt proposes prior approval for ads of Schedule H, H1 and X drugs (Health) Times of India
- Centre to cap trade margins on non-scheduled cancer drugs to 30% of MRP (Health) Times of India
- Up to 30 per cent of cotton area under 'illegal' GM hybrids, finds study (Agriculture & Allied) Indian Express
- West Asian Crisis and Securing... (International Relations) Drishti IAS
- India is defining 'DPI 2.0' as it shifts beyond identity and payments (Governance & Policy) Biometric Update
- PM calls for global framework on cyber fraud, deepfakes;asks govts, telcos, financial cos to team up (Governance & Policy) thekashmirimages.com

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 15 must-know, 22 Prelims facts, 40 in the news, 22 editorials, 17 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (6), International Relations (6), Polity & Constitution (5), Health (4), Environment & Ecology (4), Governance & Policy (4), Science & Technology (2), Infrastructure & Energy (2), History, Art & Culture (2), Defence (2). **Nothing today in —** Social Justice & Welfare, Education, Agriculture & Allied, Internal Security, Disaster Management, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 2 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 47 of 76 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 11, PIB 10, Economic Times 6, Hindustan Times 4, ForumIAS 4, Indian Express 4, msn.com 3, Business Standard 3, Mint 3, ddnews.gov.in 2, freepressjournal.in 2, Lawtext 2, ThePrint 2, BusinessLine 2

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